TOPIC REPORTS: REGIONAL COLLABORATION

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News, Sep – Oct 2026

STRATEGIES, PLANS AND POLICIES · LEGISLATION AND REGULATION · DATA PROTECTION · REGIONAL COLLABORATION · STANDARDS · PUBLIC DEBATE AND PARTICIPATION IN POLICYMAKING

Algeria · Angola · Benin · Burkina Faso · Cameroon · Chad · Comoros · Congo · Cote d'Ivoire · Djibouti · DR Congo · Egypt · Eswatini · Ethiopia · Gabon · Ghana · Guinea · Kenya · Lesotho · Liberia · Libya · Madagascar · Malawi · Mali · Mauritius · Morocco · Mozambique · Namibia · Niger · Nigeria · Rwanda · Sierra Leone · Somalia · South Africa · South Sudan · Togo · Tunisia · Uganda · Zimbabwe

Algeria

TRANS-SAHARAN INTEGRATION PROJECTS WITH NIGER

- **Cooperation Niger Telecom - Algerie Telecom : Un partenariat pour renforcer les capacites des infrastructures telecoms du Niger** — Le Sahel, 9 September 2026 NIGER

  Niger's telecoms and post college ESCEP signed a convention with Algérie Télécom's Skills Centers network in Niamey on 8 September 2026, at a meeting chaired by the communication ministry's secretary-general. The agreement provides for a Skills Center at ESCEP with Algérie Télécom's support, aimed at training and the capacity of Niger's telecoms infrastructure. No cost is given.

- **Cooperation Niger - Algerie : Une delegation algerienne visite l'ESCEP dans le cadre d'un partenariat axe sur le numerique** — Le Sahel, 10 September 2026 NIGER

  Niger's telecommunications and post college received an Algerian mission led by the adviser for partnership and development of that country's operator skills-centre network. The visit follows a partnership accord of July aimed at establishing a digital competence centre, and is presented as reflecting the two heads of state's intent.

- **L'Algérie et le Niger lancent l'exploitation de la dorsale transsaharienne à fibre optique** — Algérie Eco (reporting Algérie Presse Service), 6 October 2026 NIGER

  The Algerian account of the Assamaka ceremony, summarised above, says the link was built by Algerie Telecom and Niger Telecom, starts at 100 Gbps and can be expanded as traffic grows.

- **Niger-Algérie : lancement à Assamaka de l'exploitation de la dorsale transsaharienne à fibre optique** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 6 October 2026 NIGER

  Niger and Algeria launched operation of the fibre link between In Guezzam and the Arlit-Agadez region at a ceremony at Assamaka, on the border, on 6 October, chaired by the two communications ministers. Algeria's account gives a starting capacity of 100 Gbps.

Angola

INTERNATIONAL DECLARATION ON SPACE-BASED SCIENTIFIC DATA

- **International declaration on space-based scientific data.** — Élysée, 10 September 2026 DRC MADAGASCAR MAURITIUS RWANDA TUNISIA GLOBAL

  Angola, the Democratic Republic of Congo, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda and Tunisia are among the 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration on space-based scientific data published by France's presidency on 10 September 2026. It commits signatories to open access to satellite observation data, save for exceptions such as security and personal data, and to common exchange standards.

Benin

TRILATERAL BORDER-MODERNISATION STEERING COMMITTEE

- **Nigeria, Benin Republic move to close trade gaps at Seme Border** — Nigerian Tribune, 11 September 2026 NIGERIA

  The Nigeria Customs Service offered Benin's customs a real-time exchange of declarations, manifests, transit data, risk profiles and enforcement alerts at the Sèmè–Kraké one-stop border post on 11 September 2026. Comptroller-General Adewale Adeniyi said the two services work under one roof but not on one system; Benin's customs chief endorsed the proposal. No timetable is given.

COOPERATION AGREEMENT BETWEEN THE BENINESE AND TOGOLESE DATA-PROTECTION AUTHORITIES

- **L'Instance de Protection des Données à Caractère Personnel (IPDCP) et l'Autorité de Protection des Données Personnelles du Bénin (APDP) renforcent leur coopération à Lomé - IPDCP** — IPDCP Togo, 4 October 2026 TOGO

  Togo's data-protection authority hosted its Beninese counterpart in Lome on 2 and 3 October for a working session on sharing experience and building skills. It follows the Togolese authority's mission to Benin on 18 August and the two bodies' cooperation agreement.

SMART AFRICA CROSS-BORDER DATA EXCHANGE

- **Smart Africa moves cross-border digital ID interoperability toward live testing** — Biometric Update, 19 October 2026 GHANA RWANDA AFRICA

  Benin, Ghana and Rwanda have connected their national identity systems through the Smart Africa Data Exchange and are moving toward real-world testing of cross-border ID verification, Biometric Update reported on 19 October 2026. Pilots are planned for Benin-Rwanda air travel and Ghana-Benin land crossings. No date for live testing has been announced.

Burkina Faso

COOPERATION CONVENTION OF THE CONFEDERATION'S TELECOMS REGULATORS (CONSEIL DES RÉGULATEURS DU SAHEL)

- **Coopération régionale entre les régulateurs de l'AES : Signature d'une convention de coopération le 25 septembre 2026 à Ouagadougou** — leFaso.net (communiqué of ARCEP Burkina Faso), 23 September 2026 MALI NIGER WEST AFRICA

  The telecoms regulators of Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger are to sign a cooperation agreement in Ouagadougou on 25 September creating a Sahel Regulators' Council. It covers roaming within the Alliance of Sahel States, consumer protection, cybersecurity, spectrum, mutual recognition of type-approved equipment and joint positions in international bodies.

- **Espace AES : Les régulateurs des télécommunications créent le Conseil des régulateurs du Sahel** — leFaso.net, 26 September 2026 MALI NIGER WEST AFRICA

> The telecoms regulators of Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger signed a convention creating the Conseil des régulateurs du Sahel, reported on 26 September 2026. Its priorities include harmonised regulation, consumer protection, coordinated infrastructure and tariffs, with work on border frequency coordination, free roaming across the three states and coordinated 5G. Statutes are still to be adopted; no signing date is given.

Cameroon

> CENTRAL AFRICAN REGIONAL FRAMEWORK ON CROSS-BORDER DATA FLOWS

- **Atelier régional d'engagement des parties prenantes pour l'élaboration d'un cadre régional de la CEEAC en matière de gouvernance transfrontalière des données** — 7 jours info, 3 September 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  Experts from the Economic Community of Central African States (ECCAS) met in Douala, Cameroon, from 31 August to 4 September 2026 to review member states' readiness and agree the pillars of a regional framework on cross-border data governance. GIZ, AUDA-NEPAD, the UN Economic Commission for Africa and the African Union Commission supported the workshop technically and financially.

Chad

> CHAD-NIGERIA DIGITAL COOPERATION

- **Le ministre nigerian de l'Innovation en visite de travail au Tchad** — Tchadinfos, 16 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Chad and Nigeria signed a joint communiqué in N'Djamena on 16 September 2026 during a working visit by Nigeria's digital economy minister, Bosun Tijani. Chad's telecoms minister, Haliki Choua Mahamat, cited interest in Nigeria's 90,000km BRIDGE fibre project, which provides for a Chad–Nigeria fibre link and international capacity from Lagos. Technical teams are to work out the details.

- **Chad and Nigeria Advance Digital Cooperation on Fibre Connectivity and AI** — Tech Africa News, 17 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Chad and Nigeria agreed to strengthen cooperation in telecommunications, digital transformation and artificial intelligence after ministerial talks in N'Djamena on 16 September. Regional fibre-optic connectivity through the BRIDGE project, government service digitalisation and research were named as the areas of collaboration.

> DECLARATION OF N'DJAMENA OF THE CENTRAL AFRICAN INTERNET GOVERNANCE FORUM

- **Afrique centrale : Des engagements pour un espace numérique inclusif et souverain** — Agence tchadienne de presse et d'édition (ATPE), 15 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  Participants at the Central Africa Internet Governance Forum adopted a political declaration in N'Djamena on 15 October 2026. It calls for harmonised law on data protection, cybercrime and electronic communications, national control of strategic infrastructure, cheaper data transit and affordable access.

- **Gouvernance de l'Internet-Afrique Centrale: les participants appellent à renforcer la souveraineté numérique - Hamama Média** — Hamama Média, 15 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  The declaration closing the Central Africa Internet Governance Forum in N'Djamena asks the sub-region's heads of state to make digital sovereignty a priority, with harmonised rules on electronic communications, cybersecurity and AI. Chad said it supports the forum's three-year action plan.

- **IGF 2026 : L'Afrique centrale appelle à une coopération numérique renforcée de la sous-région** — Digital Business Africa, 15 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

The Central Africa Internet Governance Forum, held from 13 to 15 October 2026 with ECCAS, the AU Commission, UNECA and the ITU taking part, ended with a call for closer digital cooperation across the sub-region. A second cohort of the regional internet governance school was launched alongside it.

- **Numérique : clôture de l'édition 2026 du Forum sur la Gouvernance de l'Internet-Afrique Centrale - Dari Infos** — Dari Infos, 15 October 2026 `CENTRAL AFRICA`

  The 2026 Central Africa Internet Governance Forum closed in N'Djamena on 15 October after four days, with the adoption of the Declaration of N'Djamena. Its commitments include a joint CEEAC and ARTAC platform against cyberattacks by August 2027, fibre interconnection and laws on AI.

Comoros

DIGITAL-COOPERATION MEMORANDUM WITH BAHRAIN

- **iGA Holds the First Digital Government Knowledge Exchange Session with Comoros** — Information & eGovernment Authority (Bahrain), 7 October 2026

  Bahrain's Information and eGovernment Authority held its first knowledge-exchange session by video with the Comoros' National Digital Development Agency, ANADEN, reported on 7 October 2026, under a memorandum signed in June 2026. Bahrain shared how it governs and approves government IT projects and procurement. The stated aim is to raise the Comoros' score on the UN e-government index.

Congo

BRAZZAVILLE DECLARATION ON CONGO-DRC CROSS-BORDER MOBILITY

- **Congo-RDC : mobilite transfrontaliere, Brazzaville jette les bases d'un nouvel espace commun** — Groupe Congo Medias, 10 September 2026 `DRC`

  A workshop in Brazzaville from 8 September 2026, run by the association Avenir NEPAD Congo with funding from the Konrad Adenauer Foundation, examined movement and trade between the Republic of Congo and the DRC, which share a border of about 2,400km. It closed with a 'Brazzaville Declaration' proposing measures to ease crossings, secure the border and increase trade.

REGIONAL FRAMEWORK FOR NATIONAL EMERGENCY TELECOMMUNICATIONS PLANS

- **Télécoms : l'Afrique centrale renforce ses dispositifs face aux catastrophes naturelles** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 15 September 2026 `CENTRAL AFRICA`

  A regional workshop in Brazzaville on 15 and 16 September worked towards a common framework for national emergency telecommunications plans across central Africa, convened by the international telecommunications union with the regional regulators' assembly and the economic community.

Cote d'Ivoire

HOSTING OF THE FINAL AFRICAN PREPARATORY MEETING FOR THE ITU PLENIPOTENTIARY CONFERENCE 2026

- **ATU opens fifth Africa Innovation Challenge with US$60,000 prize pool** — TechReviewAfrica, 17 September 2026 `AFRICA`

  The African Telecommunications Union opened applications for the fifth Africa Innovation Challenge, with a total prize pool of US$60,000. Côte d'Ivoire's digital minister, Djibril Ouattara, launched it in Abidjan during Africa's final preparatory meeting for the 2026 ITU Plenipotentiary Conference. The call focuses on AI-based software.

- **Africa concludes final preparatory meeting ahead of ITU Plenipotentiary Conference 2026** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026 AFRICA

  African states closed their fourth and final preparatory meeting for the 2026 ITU Plenipotentiary Conference in Abidjan on 17 September 2026 with 46 African Common Proposals for the conference in Doha. The proposals cover connectivity, digital transformation, skills and inclusive digital services; space and spectrum regulation were among the most debated issues.

- **ITU Africa Regional Director Emmanuel Manasseh highlights coordinated African priorities ahead of PP-26** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026 AFRICA

  The International Telecommunication Union's Africa director, Emmanuel Manasseh, said African states refined common proposals for the 2026 Plenipotentiary Conference at their fourth and final preparatory meeting in Abidjan, reported on 18 September 2026. The next step is an inter-regional preparatory meeting in Saudi Arabia on 13 and 14 October 2026.

- **Space regulation emerges as key issue ahead of ITU Plenipotentiary Conference 2026** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026 AFRICA

  African telecommunications bodies concluded their last preparatory meeting for the 2026 ITU Plenipotentiary Conference in Abidjan, where space regulation was widely debated, reported on 18 September 2026. Eric Fournier, France's candidate to head the ITU Radiocommunication Bureau, presented his candidacy and met Côte d'Ivoire's digital minister and telecoms regulator.

Djibouti

DIGITAL COOPERATION ORGANIZATION MEMBERSHIP

- **Djibouti and DCO discuss cooperation on AI and digital transformation** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026

  Digital Cooperation Organization secretary-general Deemah AlYahya and Djibouti's digital economy minister Safia Mohamed Ali Gadileh discussed cooperation on AI, digital skills, innovation and capacity building. Djibouti recently unveiled a National AI Strategy for 2026–2030. No agreement, funding or timetable is reported.

DR Congo

INTERNATIONAL DECLARATION ON SPACE-BASED SCIENTIFIC DATA

- **International declaration on space-based scientific data.** — Élysée, 10 September 2026 ANGOLA MADAGASCAR MAURITIUS RWANDA TUNISIA GLOBAL

  Angola, the Democratic Republic of Congo, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda and Tunisia are among the 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration on space-based scientific data published by France's presidency on 10 September 2026. It commits signatories to open access to satellite observation data, save for exceptions such as security and personal data, and to common exchange standards.

Egypt

CHAIRMANSHIP OF THE ARAB AI GOVERNANCE AND QUANTUM WORKING GROUPS

- **مصر تبحث توحيد جهود حوكمة الذكاء الاصطناعي وتعزيز السيادة الرقمية وحماية البيانات عربيا** — Fintech Gate, 16 September 2026

Egypt's Ministry of Communications and Information Technology took part in the second AI summit organised by the Arab ICT Organization and the Arab League in Hammamet, Tunisia, from 7 to 10 September 2026. The ministry joined sessions on AI governance, trust and digital sovereignty, and on women in AI, where an alliance of Arab and African women in AI leadership was launched.

CAIRO DOCUMENT FOR TRUST AND AFRICAN DIGITAL INTEGRATION

- **African diplomats in Cairo agree to develop African digital integration roadmap** — Ahram Online, 4 October 2026 AFRICA

  Representatives of 11 African diplomatic missions in Cairo agreed to draft a joint Cairo Document for Trust and African Digital Integration. It is to set shared priorities on digital investment, digital trade, cybersecurity, data governance and emerging technologies.

Eswatini

COOPERATION TALKS WITH THE DIGITAL COOPERATION ORGANIZATION

- **Eswatini and DCO explore cooperation to accelerate digital transformation** — TechReview Africa, 3 September 2026

  The Digital Cooperation Organization's secretary-general, Deemah AlYahya, met Eswatini's ICT minister Savannah Maziya to discuss cooperation on digital transformation through knowledge exchange and capacity building. The report cites about 1.76 million mobile connections for a population of 1.3 million and 4G coverage of nearly 95 per cent. No agreement was announced.

COMMUNICATIONS REGULATORS' MEMORANDUM WITH LESOTHO

- **Eswatini, Lesotho Join Forces to Tackle Cyber Threats** — Eswatini Positive News, 7 October 2026 LESOTHO

  The Eswatini Communications Commission and the Lesotho Communications Authority signed a memorandum of understanding on 3 October 2026 covering information exchange, joint research, staff development and cybersecurity cooperation, including coordinated incident response, awareness campaigns, training and audits. No budget or timetable is given.

Ethiopia

HORIZON FIBER TERRESTRIAL CORRIDOR

- **Projet de fibre optique « Horizon » : Une nouvelle autoroute numérique pour la Corne de l'Afrique** — La Nation, 9 September 2026 DJIBOUTI SUDAN

  Djibouti Telecom, Ethio telecom and Sudatel presented their Horizon terrestrial fibre project to Google, Meta, Microsoft, Amazon and other carriers and vendors in Addis Ababa on 7 September 2026. The multi-terabit link would connect cable landing stations in Djibouti and Port Sudan through Ethiopia, reducing reliance on Red Sea submarine cables. No cost or launch date is given.

Gabon

STUDY VISIT TO THE RWANDAN E-GOVERNMENT MODEL

- **E-gouvernance : Gabon, Guinée, Liberia… le Rwanda attire les administrations africaines venues étudier son modèle numérique** — Digital Business Africa, 1 September 2026 RWANDA GUINEA LIBERIA

> Rwanda Cooperation said it hosted eight government delegations from seven countries in one week in late August 2026: Liberia, Kenya, Nigeria, Benin, Gambia, Gabon and Guinea. A delegation from Gabon's interior ministry spent nearly two weeks studying e-government, AI policy, digital civil registration and identification, cybersecurity, data protection and system interconnection.

> CANDIDACY FOR THE INTERNATIONAL TELECOMMUNICATION UNION COUNCIL

- **Gabon/Numérique : le pays sa candidature au Conseil de l'Union internationale des télécommunications** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse (AGP), 3 September 2026

  Gabon's digital economy minister, Mark-Alexandre Doumba, presented the country's candidacy for the International Telecommunication Union Council at the WTPF-26 forum in Nassau, Bahamas. The election takes place at the ITU Plenipotentiary Conference in Doha in November 2026. The bid cites national work on fibre interconnection and two Tier III data centres, the government's Carrier Hôtel and the Nkok facility.

> UNITED NATIONS CONVENTION AGAINST CYBERCRIME

- **Multilatéralisme : le Gabon renforce son engagement contre les menaces nucléaires et numériques** — GabonReview, 24 September 2026

  Gabon's foreign minister, Marie-Édith Tassyla-Ye-Doumbeneny, signed the UN Convention against Cybercrime on 23 September 2026 during the UN General Assembly's high-level week, alongside the Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons. Gabon presents the convention as a framework for mutual legal assistance and exchange of electronic evidence. It has signed, not ratified.

> ACCESSION TO THE BUDAPEST CONVENTION ON CYBERCRIME

- **Gabon Strengthens Cybersecurity Expertise at Octopus 2026 Conference** — Tech Africa News, 16 October 2026

  A delegation from Gabon's digital infrastructure agency, ANINF, attended the Council of Europe's Octopus 2026 cybercrime conference in Strasbourg on 14-16 October. ANINF says it used the meeting to build expertise on electronic evidence and to look at Gabon joining the Budapest Convention on Cybercrime.

Ghana

> AFCFTA DIGITAL TRADE CORRIDOR JOINT VENTURE

- **AfCFTA Digital Trade Corridor to Cut Cost of Intra-African Commerce - Wamkele Mene** — MyDailyNewsOnline, 1 September 2026 AFRICA

  The AfCFTA Secretary-General set out the case for the Digital Trade Corridor: cutting the cost and complexity of intra-African business by ending the routing of African payments through third countries.

- **Make Africa's digital trade corridor work** — Ghanaian Times, 1 September 2026 AFRICA

  An editorial on what the AfCFTA Digital Trade Corridor has to get right to matter, following the joint venture agreement signed in Accra. See the corridor entry above.

- **Africa Builds a Digital Highway for Trade** — Business Times (Uganda), 9 September 2026 AFRICA

  The AfCFTA Secretariat and Ghanaian technology company Quest Ghana signed a joint venture agreement in Accra on 31 August 2026 to set up a continental Digital Trade Corridor. It is to build digital infrastructure for payments, commodity trading, marketplaces and logistics. The US$5.17 billion figure reported is Quest Ghana's own valuation, not a stated commitment.

CHAIR OF THE AFRICAN UNION TECHNICAL COMMITTEE ON ICT

- **Sam George to chair AU ICT committee for two years** — MyJoyOnline, 7 September 2026

  Ghana's communications minister was unanimously confirmed as the next chair of the African Union technical committee on communication and ICT, for two years.

HOST OF THE 15TH AFRICA INTERNET GOVERNANCE FORUM

- **Webinar 09 Sep 13:00 UTC - Road to Ghana: Community Engagement Series #1** — ISOC Live Noticeboard, 7 September 2026 AFRICA

  The Africa Internet Governance Forum secretariat announced an online session on 9 September 2026, the first in a series ahead of the 15th Africa IGF, which Ghana hosts in Accra on 2-5 November 2026. The session covers how national, regional and youth IGF initiatives can implement the WSIS+20 outcomes and the Global Digital Compact in Africa.

BANK OF GHANA MEMORANDUM WITH THE CENTRAL BANK OF LIBERIA ON PAYMENT SYSTEMS

- **Bank of Ghana and Liberia central bank strengthen partnership on payment systems** — Ghana Guardian, 3 October 2026 LIBERIA

  A Central Bank of Liberia delegation led by Executive Governor Henry Saamoi visited the Bank of Ghana in Accra on 1 October 2026 to learn how Ghana set up its interbank payment and settlement system, GhIPSS, to inform Liberia's own payment-systems work. The visit falls under a capacity-building memorandum the two central banks signed earlier in 2026.

- **Liberia Studies Ghana's Payment Switch as It Expands Instant Transfers** — NewsGhana, 4 October 2026 LIBERIA

  The governor of the Central Bank of Liberia led a delegation to the Bank of Ghana on 1 October to study how Ghana set up its interbank payment and settlement company. Liberia is working to connect its banks to the instant payment system it switched on in December 2025.

UN CONVENTION ON NEGOTIABLE CARGO DOCUMENTS

- **Ghana to host UN convention signing on digital cargo documents on October 26** — MyJoyOnline, 16 October 2026

  Ghana will host the signing ceremony for the UN Convention on Negotiable Cargo Documents in Accra on 26 October 2026. The Ghana Shippers' Authority says the convention gives electronic bills of lading and similar documents the legal standing of paper ones, but that the benefits depend on ratification and readiness.

SMART AFRICA DATA EXCHANGE CROSS-BORDER DIGITAL ID INTEROPERABILITY PILOT

- **Smart Africa moves cross-border digital ID interoperability toward live testing** — Biometric Update, 19 October 2026 BENIN RWANDA AFRICA

  Benin, Ghana and Rwanda have connected their national identity systems through the Smart Africa Data Exchange and are moving toward real-world testing of cross-border ID verification, Biometric Update reported on 19 October 2026. Pilots are planned for Benin-Rwanda air travel and Ghana-Benin land crossings. No date for live testing has been announced.

Guinea

STUDY VISIT TO THE RWANDAN E-GOVERNMENT MODEL

- **E-gouvernance : Gabon, Guinée, Liberia… le Rwanda attire les administrations africaines venues étudier son modèle numérique** — Digital Business Africa, 1 September 2026 RWANDA GABON LIBERIA

  Rwanda Cooperation said it hosted eight government delegations from seven countries in one week in late August 2026: Liberia, Kenya, Nigeria, Benin, Gambia, Gabon and Guinea. A delegation from Gabon's interior ministry spent nearly two weeks studying e-government, AI policy, digital civil registration and identification, cybersecurity, data protection and system interconnection.

PLATEFORME DES REGULATEURS DE L'AUDIOVISUEL OF UEMOA STATES AND GUINEA (PRA-UEMOA-GUINEE)

- **PRA-UEMOA-Guinée : la HAC et l'ONC-Niger passent aux actes avec plusieurs résolutions** — Guineenews, 26 September 2026 NIGER

  Guinea's media regulator, the Haute Autorité de la Communication, and Niger's Observatoire national de la communication met in Conakry on 26 September 2026 under the regional audiovisual regulators' platform PRA-UEMOA-Guinée. In a joint communiqué they agreed to press digital platforms for protocols on algorithm transparency, promote media and digital literacy, and pursue the platform's 2026–2028 roadmap.

Kenya

CONTINENTAL BEHAVIOURAL INTELLIGENCE AND INFODEMIC MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

- **Africa CDC Calls for Stronger Community Engagement and Behavioural Intelligence to Boost Health Security** — Ommy Dallah, 3 September 2026 AFRICA

  Africa CDC held a continental workshop in Mombasa to harmonise a common framework for behavioural intelligence and infodemic management in public health. Delegates from Kenya, Ghana, Zimbabwe, Burundi and Mauritania attended, and Africa CDC's senior regional representative urged countries to use available technology for health surveillance and communication. No cost or timetable for the framework is given.

- **Africa CDC advances public health intelligence framework** — The Star (Kenya), 4 September 2026 AFRICA

  Africa CDC and member states validated components of a continental behavioural intelligence and infodemic management framework at a five-day meeting in Mombasa, with participants from six countries alongside the ECOWAS regional surveillance centre and the WHO Africa Infodemic Response Alliance. The framework is to turn community feedback, social listening, service-delivery and programme data and rapid research into decision-ready intelligence; Africa CDC states it is not another database or reporting platform.

MALABO CONVENTION RATIFICATION POSITION

- **Invitation: High-Level Malabo Convention Dialogue – Monday, 7th September 2026** — Kenya ICT Action Network (KICTANet), 4 September 2026

  Kenya ICT Action Network invited members, on behalf of Mzalendo Trust, to a parliamentary breakfast dialogue in Nairobi on 7 September 2026 on Kenya's accession to the African Union's Malabo Convention. Members of the National Assembly's communication committee, the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner and civil society were to attend; seven places were offered to network members.

KENYA-ARMENIA DIGITAL COOPERATION TALKS

- **Kenya and Armenia Explore Digital Cooperation in AI, Cloud and Youth Skills** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

Kenya and Armenia have opened discussions on cooperation in digital technologies, education, ICT, trade and investment, after a meeting between the ICT principal secretary and Armenia's ambassador. Artificial intelligence and cloud computing were identified as potential areas alongside youth skills; no instrument has been signed.

CROSS-BORDER DIGITAL PUBLIC SERVICE PILOT AMONG AFRICAN UNION STATES

- **UNGA81: Kenya proposes cross-border digital public service pilot for Africa** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

  ICT Cabinet Secretary William Kabogo proposed that willing African Union member states jointly pilot one cross-border public service and report back by February 2027. He made the proposal at an AUC-Google ministerial roundtable in New York, pointing to eCitizen's more than 22,500 services and Kenya's Government Interoperability Framework.

DIGITAL COOPERATION ORGANIZATION MEMBERSHIP

- **Kenya Signs DCO Charter on the Sidelines of UNGA81** — African Eye Report (DCO announcement), 28 September 2026

  Kenya signed the Digital Cooperation Organization Charter on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly in New York, becoming a signatory member on the way to full accession. ICT Cabinet Secretary William Kabogo Gitau signed for Kenya. The organisation says Kenya is one of eight approved candidates whose accession would raise membership from 16 to 24 countries. The signing date is not given.

Lesotho

SMART ONE-STOP BORDER POSTS WITH SOUTH AFRICA AT MASERU AND FICKSBURG

- **Lesotho-South Africa Bi-National Commission (BNC) Mid-term Review Concludes in Pretoria** — Government of Lesotho (via APO Group), 10 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Lesotho and South Africa concluded a mid-term review of their Bi-National Commission in Pretoria on 9 September 2026 after three days of talks. Outcomes included faster work on Smart One-Stop Border Posts at Maseru and Ficksburg, progress on a new migration model for labour mobility, and Phase II of the Lesotho Highlands Water Project. The next full session is set for South Africa in 2027.

COMMUNICATIONS REGULATORS' MEMORANDUM WITH ESWATINI

- **Eswatini, Lesotho Join Forces to Tackle Cyber Threats** — Eswatini Positive News, 7 October 2026 ESWATINI

  The Eswatini Communications Commission and the Lesotho Communications Authority signed a memorandum of understanding on 3 October 2026 covering information exchange, joint research, staff development and cybersecurity cooperation, including coordinated incident response, awareness campaigns, training and audits. No budget or timetable is given.

Liberia

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REVENUE AUTHORITY ASSISTANCE TO THE GAMBIA ON A REVENUE COLLECTION DASHBOARD

- **GRA and Liberia Revenue Authority sign deal to deepen digital cooperation** — The Point, 21 September 2026 GAMBIA

  The Gambian account of the Liberia–Gambia revenue dashboard agreement, summarised under the GNN Liberia report. It adds that the LRA pays the expert's airfare while the GRA covers lodging and local transport.

- **LRA to Provide Technical Support for Gambia's Revenue Collection Dashboard** — Global News Network Liberia, 21 September 2026 GAMBIA

  The Liberia Revenue Authority signed a memorandum of engagement to help the Gambia Revenue Authority build a dashboard that tracks revenue collection; it was announced from Accra on 20 September 2026 and signed during meetings of the West African Tax Administration Forum. The help covers a review of GRA's data sources, choice of indicators, design, a prototype, integration and staff training. The LRA will send the developer of its own dashboard to Banjul for an initial three weeks.

CENTRAL BANK MEMORANDUM WITH THE BANK OF GHANA ON PAYMENT SYSTEMS

- **Bank of Ghana and Liberia central bank strengthen partnership on payment systems** — Ghana Guardian, 3 October 2026 GHANA

  A Central Bank of Liberia delegation led by Executive Governor Henry Saamoi visited the Bank of Ghana in Accra on 1 October 2026 to learn how Ghana set up its interbank payment and settlement system, GhIPSS, to inform Liberia's own payment-systems work. The visit falls under a capacity-building memorandum the two central banks signed earlier in 2026.

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  The governor of the Central Bank of Liberia led a delegation to the Bank of Ghana on 1 October to study how Ghana set up its interbank payment and settlement company. Liberia is working to connect its banks to the instant payment system it switched on in December 2025.

Libya

ARAB STATES HIGH-LEVEL DIGITAL AND AI POLICY FORUM

- **UNDP, Ooredoo Group and Doha Institute for Graduate Studies convene Arab digital policy leaders to accelerate digital and AI policy implementation** — United Nations Development Programme, 2 September 2026

  UNDP, Ooredoo Group and the Doha Institute for Graduate Studies held a forum for Arab digital and AI policy leaders in Doha on 1–2 September 2026, with GSMA and Women in AI. It opened the country-level phase of the Digital Policy Framework for the Arab States, launched in November 2025. Libya's Minister of State for Digital Economy and AI, Ziad Abdelwaret Elhajjaji, took part.

Madagascar

INTERNATIONAL DECLARATION ON SPACE-BASED SCIENTIFIC DATA

- **International declaration on space-based scientific data.** — Élysée, 10 September 2026 ANGOLA DRC MAURITIUS RWANDA TUNISIA GLOBAL

  Angola, the Democratic Republic of Congo, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda and Tunisia are among the 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration on space-based scientific data published by France's presidency on 10 September 2026. It commits signatories to open access to satellite observation data, save for exceptions such as security and personal data, and to common exchange standards.

Malawi

DIGITAL AND INNOVATION COOPERATION WITH JAPAN

- **Japan deepens Malawi innovation ties** — ITWeb Africa, 1 September 2026

  Japan's ambassador to Malawi met the communications regulator's director general with a Japanese delegation, exploring stronger digital and innovation ties. Nothing was signed.

Mali

COMMON REGIONAL FRAMEWORK FOR REGULATING SOCIAL MEDIA

- **Souverainete numerique : l''AES vers une regulation commune des reseaux sociaux** — Mali24, 3 September 2026

  Mali's communication and digital economy ministry met online press, data protection, cybercrime and media regulation bodies in Bamako on 2 September 2026 to discuss common social media rules across the Alliance of Sahel States. A framework developed in Burkina Faso was proposed as the model, requiring platforms to offer reporting tools, set handling deadlines, give reasons for removals and keep removed content as evidence.

REGIONAL FIBRE INFRASTRUCTURE PROGRAMME AFTER THE ECOWAS WITHDRAWAL

- **Regional Fiber Infrastructure | Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS)** — Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) — SIGTEL, 3 September 2026

  ECOWAS's regional infrastructure inventory lists 14 internet exchange points and 15 data centres across West Africa, and 35 submarine cable landing points with a combined design capacity of 305.17 Tbps. Mali has one exchange point, Mali IX in Bamako, no cable landing, and its government data-centre status is recorded as unconfirmed. The page is undated.

COOPERATION CONVENTION OF THE CONFEDERATION TELECOMMUNICATIONS REGULATORS (CONSEIL DES RÉGULATEURS DU SAHEL)

- **Coopération régionale entre les régulateurs de l'AES : Signature d'une convention de coopération le 25 septembre 2026 à Ouagadougou** — leFaso.net (communiqué of ARCEP Burkina Faso), 23 September 2026 BURKINA FASO NIGER WEST AFRICA

  The telecoms regulators of Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger are to sign a cooperation agreement in Ouagadougou on 25 September creating a Sahel Regulators' Council. It covers roaming within the Alliance of Sahel States, consumer protection, cybersecurity, spectrum, mutual recognition of type-approved equipment and joint positions in international bodies.

- **Espace AES : Les régulateurs des télécommunications créent le Conseil des régulateurs du Sahel** — leFaso.net, 26 September 2026 BURKINA FASO NIGER WEST AFRICA

The telecoms regulators of Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger signed a convention creating the Conseil des régulateurs du Sahel, reported on 26 September 2026. Its priorities include harmonised regulation, consumer protection, coordinated infrastructure and tariffs, with work on border frequency coordination, free roaming across the three states and coordinated 5G. Statutes are still to be adopted; no signing date is given.

Mauritius

INTERNATIONAL DECLARATION ON SPACE-BASED SCIENTIFIC DATA

- **International declaration on space-based scientific data.** — Élysée, 10 September 2026 ANGOLA DRC MADAGASCAR RWANDA TUNISIA GLOBAL

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Morocco

ESCWA MEMORANDUM ON DIGITAL GOVERNANCE

- **ESCWA and Morocco Sign Regional Partnership to Advance Digital Governance** — Tech Africa News, 3 September 2026

  The UN Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia and Morocco's minister for digital transition signed a memorandum in Rabat framing regional cooperation on modernising public administration and digital governance reform.

Mozambique

TRIDIGITAL PUBLIC-INSTITUTION DIGITAL MATURITY PROJECT

- **Moçambique integra projecto para avaliar maturidade digital das instituições públicas** — MZNews, 9 October 2026 ANGOLA GUINEA-BISSAU SÃO TOMÉ

  Mozambique's ICT institute, INTIC, has joined TriDigital, a project to build a common framework and bilingual platform for assessing the digital maturity of public institutions in Angola, Guinea-Bissau, Mozambique and São Tomé and Príncipe, with the United Nations University and Argentine and Portuguese partners. It runs from September 2026 to January 2028 with a budget of €124,030.

MOZAMBIQUE-ETHIOPIA DIGITAL IDENTITY MEMORANDUM

- **ATDI, MJCR, DNIC, SENAMI e INATRO preparam implementação da Identidade Digital em Moçambique** — MozNews, 13 October 2026

  Mozambique's digital agency is leading a 14-member technical mission to Ethiopia to prepare a national digital identity, with staff from the justice ministry, civil identification, the migration service and the road-transport institute.

Namibia

AFCFTA DIGITAL TRADE REGULATORY ASSESSMENT

- **Namibia reviews digital trade framework for AfCFTA protocol implementation** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

Namibia's assessment of its laws and institutions against the African free-trade area's Protocol on Digital Trade went to a validation workshop in Windhoek. It will feed a National Digital Trade Action Plan; no findings are published.

Niger

PLATFORM OF AES MEDIA AND COMMUNICATION REGULATORS (PAREMEC)

- **AES : Création à Niamey d'une plateforme des régulateurs des médias et communication de l'espace communautaire** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 17 September 2026

  Media and communication regulators from the Alliance of Sahel States met in Niamey on 17–18 September 2026 for the constitutive conference of a joint regulators' platform, on the theme of informational sovereignty and countering disinformation. Niger's communication ministry said the platform should share expertise and set up a common monitoring and alert mechanism on information threats.

- **Fin des travaux de l'assemblée générale constitutive des régulateurs de la communication AES: Le Malien Coulibaly Gaoussou devient le 1er président de la plateforme - Agence Nigérienne de Presse** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 18 September 2026

  Media and communication regulators of the Alliance of Sahel States founded a joint platform, PAREMEC, at a constitutive assembly in Niamey that closed on 18 September 2026, with its seat in Niamey and Mali's communication authority head Coulibaly Gaoussou as first president. Recommendations to governments included laws regulating traditional and digital media, tools to monitor digital content, and a common approach to digital platforms.

COOPERATION CONVENTION OF THE CONFEDERATION TELECOMMUNICATIONS REGULATORS (CONSEIL DES RÉGULATEURS DU SAHEL)

- **Coopération régionale entre les régulateurs de l'AES : Signature d'une convention de coopération le 25 septembre 2026 à Ouagadougou** — leFaso.net (communiqué of ARCEP Burkina Faso), 23 September 2026 BURKINA FASO MALI WEST AFRICA

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Nigeria

PAPSS PARTICIPATION

- **Nigerian churches drive rising cross-border payments across Africa, PAPSS says** — Nairametrics, 5 September 2026 AFRICA

The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (PAPSS) operates in 30 African countries and aims for about 38 by the end of 2026, its chief executive Mike Ogbalu said on 5 September 2026. He said PAPSS is exploring support for stablecoins, that Nigeria–Rwanda volumes are nearing Nigeria–Ghana volumes, and that church tithes sent to Nigeria from across Africa are a notable share of payments.

- **PAPSS: Notes from a briefing with CEO Mike Ogbalu III** — Nigeriaworks (Tolu Ogunlesi), 7 September 2026 AFRICA

  Mike Ogbalu, chief executive of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System launched by Afreximbank in 2022, briefed journalists in Lagos on its move to a second strategic plan from 2027. He said Afreximbank's settlement guarantee has grown from $500 million to $3 billion, that 15 central bank governors sit on its governing council, and that PAPSS has launched a currency marketplace and a card scheme.

- **Nigeria, fintechs critical to Africa's payment integration** — The Sun Nigeria, 8 September 2026 AFRICA

  The chief executive of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, Mike Ogbalu III, told journalists in Lagos that the system lets businesses settle cross-border trade in local currencies and is drawing informal trade into the formal economy. He described its fraud controls, currency exchange arrangements and aim of covering the whole continent, and placed Nigeria's fintech sector at the centre of that effort.

NIGERIA-BENIN-CAMEROON CUSTOMS BORDER MODERNISATION (TRILATERAL STRATEGIC STEERING COMMITTEE)

- **Nigeria, Cameroon Bilateral Customs Coalition Set to Streamline Mfum-Ekok Trade** — Khal-El, 12 September 2026 CAMEROON

  The Nigeria Customs Service and Cameroon's customs administration began a joint assessment of the Ekok-Mfum one-stop border post on 8 September 2026 and launched a border modernisation initiative to digitise customs workflows. Cameroon's customs director general Fongod Nuvaga called for real-time data sharing and joint risk management; a joint operational agreement is being drafted. No cost or completion date is given.

- **Bénin-Nigeria : les douanes interconnectent leurs systèmes pour accélérer le commerce** — wearetech.africa, 15 September 2026 BENIN

  The two countries' customs administrations launched a pilot interconnection of their systems at the Seme-Krake border post on 11 September, to exchange data in real time and cut repeated formalities.

- **Customs, Afreximbank plan Nigeria-Benin, Cameroon border upgrade** — Vanguard News, 18 October 2026 BENIN CAMEROON

  Nigeria Customs Service opened talks with Afreximbank on modernising the Sèmè–Kraké and Mfum–Ekok border corridors with Benin and Cameroon. The plans include a system for exchanging customs declarations between the three countries on a common data model; no cost or loan has been agreed.

CHAD-NIGERIA DIGITAL COOPERATION

- **Le ministre nigerian de l'Innovation en visite de travail au Tchad** — Tchadinfos, 16 September 2026 CHAD

  Chad and Nigeria signed a joint communiqué in N'Djamena on 16 September 2026 during a working visit by Nigeria's digital economy minister, Bosun Tijani. Chad's telecoms minister, Haliki Choua Mahamat, cited interest in Nigeria's 90,000km BRIDGE fibre project, which provides for a Chad–Nigeria fibre link and international capacity from Lagos. Technical teams are to work out the details.

- **Chad and Nigeria Advance Digital Cooperation on Fibre Connectivity and AI** — Tech Africa News, 17 September 2026 CHAD

Chad and Nigeria agreed to strengthen cooperation in telecommunications, digital transformation and artificial intelligence after ministerial talks in N'Djamena on 16 September. Regional fibre-optic connectivity through the BRIDGE project, government service digitalisation and research were named as the areas of collaboration.

ECOWAS BIOMETRIC IDENTITY CARD

- **Africa: How Ecowas Biometric Card Will Ease Travel for Member States' Citizens Across West Africa - Officials** — Premium Times (Abuja), via allAfrica.com, 17 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Officials said at a Lagos workshop that seven ECOWAS member states — Senegal, Guinea-Bissau, Ghana, Benin, The Gambia, Sierra Leone and Nigeria — have deployed the regional biometric identity card, which is intended to replace the handwritten regional travel certificate. The chip carries the issuing authority's digital signature over the stored identity data, so any alteration breaks the trust chain at border authentication; member states committed in April to work towards mutual acceptance at borders by December.

- **ECOWAS steps up citizen biometric identity push for seamless cross-border travel** — Tribune Online, 17 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  At a Lagos workshop on the regional biometric identity card, Nigeria's immigration service said the card serves the same purpose as the regional passport within the subregion, is renewable every five years, costs N35,500 and is applied for online with a single physical visit for biometric capture. The ECOWAS Commission framed it as harmonising identification and addressing cross-border crime and irregular migration.

- **ECOWAS Biometric Card Will Ease Travel, Enhance Free Trade in Member States, Say IOM, NIS, ECOWAS** — ThisDay, 18 September 2026

  At a Lagos media workshop the migration organisation, Nigeria's immigration service and the ECOWAS Commission set out the case for the regional biometric identity card, presenting it as the instrument of the free movement protocol and as conferring the right to live and trade in any member state. The card is put at N35,000 to acquire, a figure another account of the same workshop gives as N35,500.

NIGERIA-UNITED KINGDOM CUSTOMS MUTUAL ADMINISTRATIVE ASSISTANCE AGREEMENT

- **Nigeria, UK Customs Target Faster Trade With New Data-Sharing Deal** — Nigeria Updates, 27 September 2026

  The Nigeria Customs Service and the UK's HM Revenue and Customs met in Abuja to finalise a Customs Mutual Administrative Assistance Agreement on information sharing and compliance, after about six months of virtual talks, reported on 27 September 2026. Nigerian customs said it hopes the agreement will be signed in the first week of December at the World Customs Organization Policy Commission.

Rwanda

FOREIGN GOVERNMENT DELEGATIONS STUDYING THE E-GOVERNMENT MODEL

- **E-gouvernance : Gabon, Guinée, Liberia… le Rwanda attire les administrations africaines venues étudier son modèle numérique** — Digital Business Africa, 1 September 2026 GABON GUINEA LIBERIA

  Rwanda Cooperation said it hosted eight government delegations from seven countries in one week in late August 2026: Liberia, Kenya, Nigeria, Benin, Gambia, Gabon and Guinea. A delegation from Gabon's interior ministry spent nearly two weeks studying e-government, AI policy, digital civil registration and identification, cybersecurity, data protection and system interconnection.

INTERNATIONAL DECLARATION ON SPACE-BASED SCIENTIFIC DATA

- **International declaration on space-based scientific data.** — Élysée, 10 September 2026 ANGOLA DRC MADAGASCAR MAURITIUS TUNISIA GLOBAL

  Angola, the Democratic Republic of Congo, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda and Tunisia are among the 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration on space-based scientific data published by France's presidency on 10 September 2026. It commits signatories to open access to satellite observation data, save for exceptions such as security and personal data, and to common exchange standards.

NATIONAL POSITION ON ORBITAL AND RADIO-FREQUENCY ACCESS

- **Kagame Seeks Removal of Technology Export Restrictions to Africa** — KT Press, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  Rwanda's president warned at the first International Space Summit in Paris that African countries risk losing access to valuable orbital and radio-frequency resources as the global space industry expands, and urged the continent to coordinate its interests and take a stronger voice in rule-setting. He said Africa should be a full participant in the sector rather than only a consumer of satellite services, and sought the removal of technology export restrictions.

HOSTING OF THE SEVENTH UN WORLD DATA FORUM, 2028

- **Rwanda Has Been Selected as Africa's Second UN World Data Forum Host** — RADIOTV10, 22 September 2026

  Rwanda was chosen on 21 September 2026 to host the seventh UN World Data Forum, expected in the fourth quarter of 2028. It is the second African host after South Africa, which held the first forum in Cape Town in 2017. The National Institute of Statistics of Rwanda welcomed the selection.

CROSS-BORDER DIGITAL IDENTITY PILOT

- **Smart Africa moves cross-border digital ID interoperability toward live testing** — Biometric Update, 19 October 2026 BENIN GHANA AFRICA

  Benin, Ghana and Rwanda have connected their national identity systems through the Smart Africa Data Exchange and are moving toward real-world testing of cross-border ID verification, Biometric Update reported on 19 October 2026. Pilots are planned for Benin-Rwanda air travel and Ghana-Benin land crossings. No date for live testing has been announced.

Sierra Leone

REGIONAL DATA EMBASSY FRAMEWORK PROPOSED AT ECOWAS

- **Attorney-General Defends Cautious Path to AI Legislation at UNESCO Forum in Riyadh** — Truth Media, 21 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's attorney-general told a UNESCO forum on AI ethics in Riyadh that the country has no AI-specific law and that its data-protection bill has not yet passed. He said the government would put that legal foundation in place before deploying AI, after an AI readiness diagnostic done with the World Bank.

Somalia

PEER-LEARNING COOPERATION WITH PAKISTAN ON DIGITAL IDENTITY AND PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Somalia and Pakistan deepen cooperation on digital identity and public infrastructure** — UNDP Pakistan, 16 September 2026

A Somali delegation led by the director-general of the National Identification and Registration Authority, Abdiwali Ali Abdulle, ended a ten-day UNDP-convened mission to Pakistan on 16 September 2026. It studied Pakistan's identity authority, data-exchange layer, social registry and Raast instant payments, and validated a joint action matrix on digital identity and public infrastructure.

- **Peer Learning to Collaboration: Somalia & Pakistan Deepen Partnership on Digital Infrastructure** — Somali Stream, 19 September 2026

  A 15-member Somali delegation completed a ten-day peer-learning programme on digital identity and public infrastructure in Islamabad and Lahore, designed by UNDP and the two countries' identity authorities. A Somali official said the national identity authority registers only about 2,000 people a day, far below capacity, and that Somalia has no national data exchange layer.

South Africa

REGIONAL HIGHER EDUCATION DATA SYSTEM (SADC)

- **SADC must build its own knowledge to drive industrialisation, says Manamela** — SAnews (South African Government News Agency), 1 September 2026 SOUTHERN AFRICA

  South Africa's higher education minister, Buti Manamela, told a meeting of SADC university vice-chancellors in Johannesburg on 31 August 2026 that the region must build its own computing capacity, datasets, African-language technologies and cybersecurity. He set five priorities, including agreement on a regional higher education data system, to show results by the SADC ministers' meeting in June 2027.

- **Universities should turn regional cooperation into action** — University of the Witwatersrand, 1 September 2026 SOUTHERN AFRICA

  University leaders, government representatives, the SADC Secretariat and the Southern African Regional Universities Association met at Wits University on 31 August–1 September 2026. They discussed the SADC higher education strategy, a proposed SADC University of Transformation, a regional higher education data system and micro-credentials. No design, cost or timetable for the data system is given.

South Sudan

DOMESTICATION OF THE AU DATA POLICY FRAMEWORK

- **Implementation of the AU Data Policy Framework: South Sudan Data Governance Capacity Building and Engagement Workshop — draft concept note and agenda** — KICTANet, 8 September 2026

  The African Union Commission, AUDA-NEPAD, GIZ and KICTANet convened a three-day workshop in Juba from 8 to 10 September on domesticating the African Union Data Policy Framework in South Sudan. This is a forward notice of the convening; no outcome or workplan is on record.

SOUTH SUDAN-UGANDA CROSS-BORDER HEALTH SECURITY MEMORANDUM

- **South Sudan, Uganda sign agreement on cross-border health security** — Radio Tamazuj, 8 September 2026 UGANDA

  South Sudan and Uganda's health ministers signed a memorandum of understanding in Juba on cross-border health security, reported on 8 September 2026. It provides for real-time sharing of epidemiological information, mutual outbreak notification, joint contact tracing and surveillance, biospecimen transfer and harmonised screening at points of entry.

CUSTOMS COOPERATION MEMORANDUM WITH THE UGANDA REVENUE AUTHORITY

- **South Sudan, Uganda Sign MoU to Strengthen Customs Cooperation** — Juba Echo TV, 16 September 2026 UGANDA

  The South Sudan Revenue Authority and the Uganda Revenue Authority signed their third memorandum of understanding on customs cooperation, reported on 16 September 2026, covering modernisation, digital interoperability, transit trade and capacity building. New areas include enforcement of the electronic permit system. No commencement date or text is given.

Togo

COOPERATION AGREEMENT BETWEEN THE TOGOLESE AND MALIAN DATA-PROTECTION AUTHORITIES

- **Togo, Mali Data Regulators Agree to Share Expertise** — Togo First, 25 September 2026 MALI

  Togo's personal data protection authority (IPDCP) and Mali's APDP signed a cooperation agreement on 23 September covering information exchange, joint handling of complaints and compliance checks, and staff training. Their talks also touched on cross-border data transfers, cybersecurity and AI.

COOPERATION AGREEMENT BETWEEN THE TOGOLESE AND BENINESE DATA-PROTECTION AUTHORITIES

- **L'Instance de Protection des Données à Caractère Personnel (IPDCP) et l'Autorité de Protection des Données Personnelles du Bénin (APDP) renforcent leur coopération à Lomé - IPDCP** — IPDCP Togo, 4 October 2026 BENIN

  Togo's data-protection authority hosted its Beninese counterpart in Lome on 2 and 3 October for a working session on sharing experience and building skills. It follows the Togolese authority's mission to Benin on 18 August and the two bodies' cooperation agreement.

Tunisia

AFRICAN TELECOMMUNICATIONS UNION COUNCIL SEAT

- **3rd African Preparatory Meeting for WRC-27 (APM27-3) and the 11th African Spectrum Management Conference** — African Telecommunications Union (ATU), 7 September 2026 AFRICA

  The African Telecommunications Union published the draft agenda and working-group schedule for the third African Preparatory Meeting for the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference, held in Tunis on 7–11 September 2026 alongside the 11th African Spectrum Management Conference. The agenda covers the ITU's preparatory work plan, other regions' positions and the WRC-27 agenda items.

- **African Delegations Seek Common Ground in Tunis Ahead of 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference** — African Telecommunications Union (ATU), 9 September 2026 AFRICA

  African governments and telecoms regulators opened four days of talks in Tunis on 8 September 2026 to build common spectrum positions ahead of the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference. Hosted by Tunisia's National Frequency Agency and coordinated by the African Telecommunications Union, it is the third such preparatory meeting, after Maseru in 2024 and Nairobi in 2025.

- **ATU calls for stronger spectrum policy as Africa prepares for WRC-27** — TechReviewAfrica, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  The African telecommunications union's secretary-general called for stronger alignment among African administrations on spectrum policy, at the 11th Africa spectrum management conference in Tunis. He singled out the mid-band ranges where mobile broadband demand will need capacity and coordination, and argued that policy must extend beyond identifying frequencies to how spectrum is priced and licensed.

AI FORWARD SUMMIT 2026

- كاتب دولة: قمة الذكاء الاصطناعي فضاء للحوار حول السبل الكفيلة بجعل هذه الثروة رافعة للتنمية والتعاون والسلام — Radio Nationale Tunisienne, 9 September 2026 NORTH AFRICA

  The AI Forward Summit 2026, organised by the Arab Information and Communication Technologies Organisation and Tunisia's communication technologies ministry, opened in Tunisia on 9 September 2026. Secretary of State Mohamed Ben Ayed told the opening session that Tunisia wants international cooperation on capacity-building, technology transfer and finance so developing countries produce AI rather than only consume it.

- "ياسمين الحمامات.. افتتاح قمة "الذكاء الاصطناعي نحو المستقبل 2026 — Assabah News, 9 September 2026

  The Arab ICT Organisation and Tunisia's communication technologies ministry opened the 'AI towards the Future 2026' summit in Yasmine Hammamet on 9 September 2026. Participants include the ITU, UNESCO, the Council of Europe, Smart Africa, ESCWA and the GSMA; sessions cover turning AI's technical potential into economic and social value.

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TUNIS DECLARATION ON DIGITAL HEALTH

- **TeleHealth Connect Tunisia 2026 : la Tunisie veut faire du numérique un levier d'équité en santé** — La Presse de Tunisie, 29 September 2026

  Tunisia's health minister Mustapha Ferjani said on 29 September 2026, opening the TeleHealth Connect Tunisia conference, that the ministry aims to give every citizen a unique health identifier and digital medical record before the end of 2026, hosted on a Tunisian sovereign cloud. He said more than 32 hospitals were equipped for remote imaging this year and the digital hospital has run over 120,000 radiology exams.

- إعلان تونس" للتحول الرقمي في قطاع الصحة.. التفاصيل": — Assabah News, 30 September 2026

  Tunisia's health ministry unveiled a 'Tunis Declaration' on digital health at the TeleHealth Connect 2026 conference, attended by experts from about 35 countries, reported on 30 September 2026. It commits to protecting health data and digital sovereignty under national law, treating cybersecurity as part of patient safety, responsible human-centred AI, and interoperable systems on open standards.

Uganda

UGANDA-SOUTH SUDAN CROSS-BORDER HEALTH SECURITY MEMORANDUM

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Zimbabwe

NETWORK OF AFRICAN DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITIES MEMBERSHIP

- **POTRAZ Joins Continental Partners to Commemorate Inaugural Africa Data Protection Day** — TechnoMag, 22 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's regulator POTRAZ, which acts as the country's data protection authority, marked the first Africa Data Protection Day on 21 September. The day commemorates the 2016 founding of the Network of African Data Protection Authorities, which now has 34 members and in which POTRAZ is second vice-president.

CONVENTION ON MUTUAL ADMINISTRATIVE ASSISTANCE IN TAX MATTERS

- **Zimra, ATAF Vic-Falls Indaba advances regional Tax Transparency agenda** — The Herald, 15 October 2026

  ZIMRA's acting commissioner general told the continental exchange-of-information conference it co-hosted with ATAF in Victoria Falls that Zimbabwe deposited its ratification of the Convention on Mutual Administrative Assistance in Tax Matters on 31 August 2026, in force for it from 1 January 2027. He said ZIMRA is preparing for peer review and for automatic exchange of information.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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